

Iowa Liquor Sales Analysis

2021-2025 | Google BigQuery + SQL | Retailer wholesale purchases

12.91M

records analyzed

\$424.99M

2025 net sales

-5.0%

2025 sales vs. 2024

2,243

active stores in 2025

OBJECTIVE & SQL APPROACH

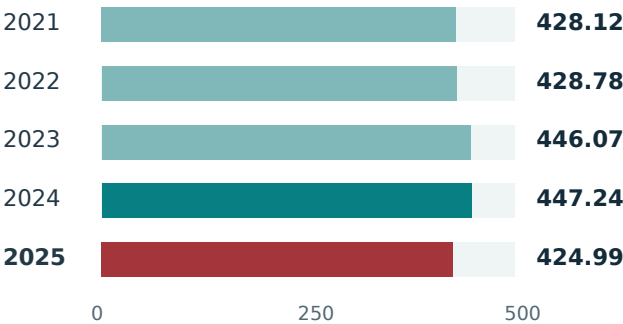
Assess sales trends, category mix, products and geographic concentration across **12,908,429 records**. A reusable BigQuery view covers five complete years, excluding partial 2026 data; aggregation, conditional counts and distinct counts support eight focused business queries.

Data Quality Control: Retained paired negative sales and quantities as likely returns/corrections, preserving net totals. Excluded zero retail prices from price calculations and unassigned locations from geographic rankings.

KEY FINDINGS

Annual net sales

USD millions | 2021-2025



Leading categories: annual change

Category	2025 vs. 2024
American Vodkas	-\$2.12M
Canadian Whiskies	-\$4.03M
Straight Bourbon Whiskies	-\$0.30M
100% Agave Tequila	-\$1.25M
Whiskey Liqueur	+\$0.50M

CATEGORY & SKU MIX | 2021-2025

American Vodkas: \$323.38M, the largest category.
Agave Tequila: \$29.00 per bottle, highest among the five leaders. Three **Tito's** SKUs occupied three of the top four product ranks.

GEOGRAPHY | 2021-2025

Polk County: \$505.92M, approximately 2.75 times **Linn**. The two largest retailer locations, **Hy-Vee 3 BDI Des Moines** and **Central City 2**, were both in Polk.

Business implication: 2025 net sales fell **\$22.25M** even as active stores rose from **2,162 to 2,243**. Sales declined in **10 of 12 months**, pointing to broad purchasing weakness that merits investigation.

RECOMMENDED PRIORITIES

- 01 Investigate category weakness.** Prioritize Canadian Whiskies and American Vodkas; track leading SKUs individually and tailor assortment reviews to category value and volume.
- 02 Review the weakest months.** Examine November, February and May ordering patterns, assortment and market conditions before attributing the decline to specific causes.
- 03 Focus geographic planning.** Start with Polk, Linn and Scott; monitor large purchasing locations alongside the wider retailer network to manage concentration.

Interpretation: Sales reflect wholesale retailer purchases, not consumer transactions. Sales per bottle reflects bottle-size and product mix, not profit. County totals are not population-adjusted. Inventory, promotion and cost data are unavailable; causes and profitability cannot be established.